Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Mona Lott

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Mona Lott

International Cultural Heritage Ambassador

Mona can turn a simple disagreement about a bowl into an international event. Mona moves between embassies, museums, ministries, and negotiation tables. Where everyone insists the issue is 'purely cultural,' Mona shows up with three lawyers and a list of demands.

- Has a long professional friendship with **Sue Venir**. Their arguments sometimes continue through dinner.
- Debates restitution policy with **Dr. Art E. Fact**, who usually brings reading material.

ACTING TIPS

Elegant, diplomatic, strategic, warm until precision is required. You can disagree without ever sounding flustered.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Mona Lott. I negotiate the return of precious objects. I expect several difficult conversations and at least one excellent croissant.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Mona Lott

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Fear of exclusion makes her borrow authority. Loyalty to Sue survives their ruthless professional opposition.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Mona Lott

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Not every throne is upholstered; check the underside of a metal one.*

2 *The artist signed the front. Somebody else has used the space behind it.*

3 *From Genesis to Revelation, a familiar book offers room for one extra document.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Mona Lott

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I came with a ministry instruction to return the bowl. Grant wanted me in his acquisition photograph instead. Imagine being invited to bless the thing you've come to stop. Sue questioned the letter. She always does notice the part of an evening everyone else has agreed to admire. I wanted a seat where the decision happened. I wasn't going home with another photograph.

IF MURDERER

Grant knew my letter wasn't a government instruction. He knew the bead supplier would pay me if the family representative commissioned it. He offered silence if I blessed his ownership. I wanted a seat where decisions happened. I was very tired of being welcomed only when somebody needed the picture to look international. He could turn even that invitation into something I owed him.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Mona Lott

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I circulated the letter. Sue asked whose authority it carried; I told her to look at the heading. I requested sealed water for Grant before the toast. He could read a demand without being handed another drink. Sue, you knew how badly I wanted to be in that room. You also chose the most public possible moment to question why I was there.

IF MURDERER

I circulated the claim letter without its source note. Sue asked whose authority it carried. Grant knew. I requested sealed water and went to his private place with the letter. The glass was already there. I put the letter under its edge so it wouldn't slide to the floor. He was elsewhere. Sue, I wanted him to read it without an audience helping him laugh. Is that really such an unreasonable thing to want?

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Mona Lott

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> The water stayed sealed. He drank the toast. The ministry stands behind my letter; that source file is incomplete. Sue, I have seen the heading you're pointing at. If the family wants to ask about the supplier's commission, let them ask. One question at a time.

IF MURDERER

> He refused the toast and drank the sealed water I requested. The engraved glass was a gift, not his drinking glass. I was there when he chose. My letter needed a better attribution, and the family wants an answer about the commission. I will answer those questions after this one.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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BALLOT

Mona Lott

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I didn't kill Grant. The water was unopened; he drank the toast. My letter was the claimants' request. No ministry gave me that authority. I borrowed the stationery's grandeur and then defended it because admitting the truth felt like being sent back outside. The supplier would have paid me a commission too. Sue, be angry with me. Please don't let that become a reason to stop hearing the claimants.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. He accepted the toast. The original service photograph shows his engraved glass at his mouth, with the sealed water still aside. I poisoned the waiting glass using what I had taken at the preview. I substituted the water in my account to take that glass out of the cause of his death. Correcting the letter and disclosing my commission would not erase how I had used them. Sue, the claimants asked for an advocate. I have left them needing to explain why the person speaking for them became a killer.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.